



READY FOR RECESSION?

The writing is on the wall.

Amid simultaneous rate hikes by central banks around the world, the World Bank has warned of a global recession next year. World Bank Group President David Malpass said global growth is slowing sharply, with further slowdown likely as more countries fall into recession and a string of financial crises show up in emerging markets and developing economies. Meanwhile, the Asian Development Bank (ADB) has trimmed its FY23 growth projection for India's economy to 7 per cent from 7.5 per cent estimated in April, calling it a "modest downward revision".

—PRERNA LIDHOO

FIVE LAKH CRORE SMILES FOR SBI

ON SEPTEMBER 14, State Bank of India (SBI) crossed ₹5 lakh crore in market capitalisation to become the third lender to touch the landmark after HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank. Shares of the bank have gained 25 per cent to ₹574.1 on a year-to-date basis till September 20. JM Financial believes SBI is a key beneficiary of the uptick in systemic credit growth. "The bank has protected its asset/liability market share over the last five years, with increasing signs of stronger corporate credit demand emerging," it said.

—RAHUL OBEROI



MAHINDRA'S TEACHER CONNECT

Mahindra Susten joins the list of firms in the renewable energy business to raise capital. A part of the \$19-billion eponymous group, it has sold a 30 per cent stake to Ontario Teachers' Pension Plan Board for \$300 million. The game for renewables hots up as big business groups move towards the next stage of expansion. Be it Adani, Mahindra or Hero, the investments are coming in from PE funds or strategic players. The next phase is expected to be hydrogen, where the big groups again have a play. Fascinating times as green is the buzzword and money pours in.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN

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THE FIGURE CROSSED BY INDIA'S NET DIRECT TAX COLLECTIONS IN FY23 TILL SEPTEMBER 17, WHICH IS 23.33 PER CENT HIGHER THAN THE CORRESPONDING PERIOD LAST YEAR

Cheaper Drugs on the Anvil



SEVERAL DRUGS ARE expected to get cheaper after the recent update in the National List of Essential Medicines (NLEM) 2022. The Union health ministry added at least 34 drugs to the NLEM 2022 and dropped 26 from the previous list. The drugs in the NLEM are scheduled drugs, which are under price control by the central government. Hence, the manufacturing companies will have to reduce the prices of these drugs. The government added medicines to treat endocrine disorders, diabetes, respiratory diseases, cancer, TB, HIV and Hepatitis C.

—NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA



FLEXI WORK IN DEMAND

Sectors like e-commerce, retail, manufacturing, BFSI and IT added 233,000 new formal contract staffers in July 2021-June 2022, as per a report by the Indian Staffing Federation. The demand has been higher after the third Covid-19 wave, with the June quarter of 2022 seeing 66,000 new flexi-workforce additions. The general staffing industry (excluding IT) drove most of the growth.

—VIDYA S.